TNERS IN PROGRESS

A FUTURE-READY ALLIANCE DRIVING INNOVATION, TRADE, TALENT AND CULTURAL TIES

Photographs by **HARDIK CHHABRA**



H.E. DR THANI BIN AHMED AL ZEYOUDI
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around infrastructure, talent, startup growth and venture creation.

Both nations recognise the imperative of an agile, AI-savvy workforce. The conclave highlighted hybrid education models combining classroom instruction, online learning and practical industry exposure to prepare youth for rapidly evolving job markets.

Tourism flows between India and the UAE extend beyond leisure; it drives cultural exchange, employment and regional development. Indian hotel groups are investing in the UAE. Meanwhile, the UAE targets niche segments such as wellness and eco-tourism, moving from volume-driven to value-focused growth.

Retail is also undergoing a profound transformation. Indian giants like Titan and Apparel Group are integrating AI-powered inventory, smart mirrors and omnichannel experiences to serve fast-paced UAE consumers while preserving India's social shopping ethos.

The conclave captured this dynamic journey: a relationship fundamentally reimagined and poised for the future. ■

—ANILESH S. MAHAJAN

"LET'S NOT REPLICATE OR DUPLICATE WHATEVER THE WEST HAS DONE.... WE HAVE TO TAILOR THINGS TO OUR OWN ECOSYSTEM, CULTURE AND MINDSET

Don't depend on the conventional way. If it has not been successful for the last 20 or 30 years, it will never be, because it's already been tried. If it's been tried once or twice and failed, just come up with a new way of doing things

WHEN IT COMES TO IMPLEMENTATION, YOU HAVE TO HAVE A CLEAR VISION. YOU CAN CHANGE YOUR TACTICS, BUT IF YOU CHANGE THE VISION, YOU'RE JUST FOOLING YOURSELF; YOU WILL NOT BE ABLE TO ACHIEVE IT"